Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa + (BRICS+)

DPSIMUN '26

CONFERENCE THEME

"Radical Resilience: Engineering Stability in an Age of Volatility"

Dais

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Committee

BRICS +

Contents

1.1 Committee Overview

BRICS+ is the expanded format of BRICS, an influential intergovernmental organization comprising major emerging economies. Originally founded as BRIC in 2009 by Brazil, Russia, India, and China, the group was renamed BRICS in 2010 with the addition of South Africa. In 2024, the bloc underwent significant expansion with the admission of Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates, followed by Indonesia in 2025, bringing the total membership to ten countries.

BRICS+ represents a dynamic platform for emerging markets seeking greater influence in global governance, economic cooperation, and financial architecture. The group aims to promote multipolarity, sustainable development, and South-South cooperation while addressing systemic inequalities in the current international order.

In line with the conference theme, “Radical Resilience: Engineering Stability in an Age of Volatility", the BRICS+ committee serves as a critical forum for member states to collaboratively design mechanisms that enhance economic resilience, reduce external dependencies, and foster long-term stability amidst geopolitical tensions, financial uncertainties, and shifting global power dynamics.

1.2 Welcome message

Dear Delegates,
It is with great pleasure that we welcome you to the BRICS+ Committee at DPSI MUN 2026!

This year’s conference theme, “Radical Resilience: Engineering Stability in an Age of Volatility”, perfectly encapsulates the spirit of our committee. In a world marked by economic uncertainty, geopolitical tensions, and rapid global shifts, the BRICS+ nations are working toward building a more resilient and self-reliant economic framework — one that reduces excessive dependence on any single economy and promotes greater financial sovereignty.

As delegates in the BRICS+ Committee, each of you carries the important responsibility of representing your assigned nation and collaborating to strengthen the economic wellbeing of member states. Through constructive debate, creative diplomacy, and meaningful negotiation, you will explore innovative solutions to some of the most pressing economic challenges of our time.

We hope this Background Guide serves as a valuable resource, providing you with essential context, key issues, and focus areas that will guide our discussions throughout the conference.

We are excited to witness your energetic debates, dynamic ideas, and impactful resolutions as you work together to shape a more balanced and stable global economic order.

We look forward to seeing you in committee!

Best regards,

The BRICS+ Dais Team

1.3 Chair Message

Yesung Kim **CHAIR, BRICS +**

Hello everyone!

My name is Yesung, and I am so excited and honored to serve as your Chair for the BRICS+ Committee at DPSIMUN!

This is my first time chairing a committee, although I’ve participated in five different MUN conferences before so I know exactly how it feels when the Chair starts talking and you’re just hoping they don’t notice you haven’t finished reading the background guide yet. I’m really excited to be on this side of the table and to guide all of you through what I hope will be an amazing experience.

My biggest advice to you is to **prepare well** — take time to really understand the topics, especially the importance of local currency usage and reducing reliance on the US Dollar. It is not the most thrilling topic at first glance, but once you read more, it gets surprisingly interesting. The success of this committee will depend on your active participation, creativity, cooperation, and respect for one another.

I genuinely think this can be one of the more interesting committees at the conference if we all put a bit of effort in. We’ll be dealing with the same kinds of questions actual BRICS diplomats argue about, just with slightly less pressure and better snacks (hopefully).

I can’t wait to meet each and every one of you soon! Feel free to reach out if you have any questions or need guidance before the committee begins. Let’s make this a memorable, productive, and fun session!

Best regards,
Yesung

Chair, BRICS+ Committee

Sumaaho Atunah-Jay **CHAIR, BRICS +**

Hello everybody!

My name is Sumaaho, and I can’t wait to be your chair in the BRICS+ Committee at DPSIMUN ‘26!
I’ve participated in 8 MUNs over 5 years but this will be the first time I chair an external conference. During my time in MUN I've learned the importance of chairs in creating a fun and memorable experience and I hope to make this conference incredible for all of you. I’m extremely excited to be your chair during this conference and I can’t wait to meet and guide you all through the conference!

Before the conference I want you all to keep in mind that **if you don’t try, you definitely won’t succeed.** This means that each and every one of you should do your very best to prepare, participate, and cooperate in this conference in order for us to have fruitful sessions. Fully understanding the topics at hand and the aim of the BRICS+ countries is crucial for debate and for creating a memorable conference.

Whether this conference is your 1st or 23rd, I truly believe that you will all be able to thrive and engage in debate. Together we will make this conference memorable and our committee will be the one of, if not the best! Remember that though we want to try our best to emulate the UN, it will also be fun so be prepared to have a good time!

I’m so excited to meet all of you and to have this experience together! Please reach out to me if you have any questions about anything. I hope we will have an amazing, productive, and unforgettable experience together!

Best wishes,
Sumaaho

Chair, BRICS+ Committee

1.4 Country List

Full BRICS+ Members (11)

1. Brazil
2. Russia
3. Indian
4. China
5. South Africa
6. Egypt
7. Ethiopia
8. Iran
9. Saudi Arabia
10. United Arab Emirates (UAE)
11. Indonesia

Official BRICS+ Partner Countries (10)

1. Belarus
2. Bolivia
3. Cuba
4. Kazakhstan
5. Malaysia
6. Nigeria
7. Thailand
8. Uganda
9. Uzbekistan
10. Vietnam

Guest countries (4)

1. Türkiye (Turkey)
2. Japan
3. South Korea
4. Australia

Topic 1

1.5 Increasing local currency usage and reducing reliance on the US Dollar

1.5.1 Background Information

The US dollar still sits at the centre of the global financial system. It's the main reserve currency, the one most trade is priced in, and the one people turn to when things get shaky. About 54% of global foreign exchange reserves are still in dollars.

A lot of countries in BRICS and beyond have started pushing back against this. Dollar swings can mess with their currencies and debt. They're frustrated with how Western-dominated the IMF and World Bank feel. And after Russia's reserves got frozen in 2022 and it was cut off from SWIFT, the risks of depending so much on the dollar became very real.

At the summits in Johannesburg (2023) and Kazan (2024), BRICS leaders kept talking about using more of their own currencies in trade and investment. The goal isn't to destroy the dollar overnight. It's to have more options so no single country can use the financial system as a weapon.

1.5.2 Historical Context

This dollar dominance didn't just happen. It was designed at Bretton Woods in 1944. Countries pegged their currencies to the dollar, and the dollar was pegged to gold. The US held most of the world's gold at the time, so it made sense then.

That system fell apart in 1971 when Nixon ended the gold convertibility (the "Nixon Shock"). Instead of the dollar losing power, it actually became more important — especially once oil started being sold almost only in dollars.

By the early 2000s the dollar was used in around 88% of international transactions. That gave the US what a French minister once called an "exorbitant privilege" — the ability to borrow cheaply and run deficits in a way other countries can't. The euro and attempts to expand the IMF's Special Drawing Rights haven't really changed that much. That's why what BRICS is trying to do now is both ambitious and difficult.

1.5.3 Current Situation

Things are moving, but slowly and practically rather than with big dramatic announcements. A full common currency is still not happening — the differences between members are just too big for now. Brazil and some others have been steering the conversation toward more realistic near-term steps.

Some relationships are already quite far along. Russia–China trade is around 90% in rubles and yuan. India–Russia is close to 96% in national currencies. The New Development Bank is also trying to give more of its loans in members' own currencies (they're aiming for 30% under the current strategy).

Payment systems are where the progress feels most concrete. BRICS Pay is being connected to existing systems like Russia's SPFS, China's CIPS and India's UPI. There's also the mBridge project with China, Hong Kong, Thailand and the UAE that lets them settle in digital versions of their own currencies in real time. Late last year there was even a pilot of a gold-linked settlement token called "the Unit," though it's still experimental.

Not everyone is equally enthusiastic. India (which is chairing BRICS in 2026) has been more cautious and often talks about the dollar's role as something that still provides stability. Russia tends to frame its shift more as a practical response to being sanctioned than as some big ideological move against the dollar.

Overall the trend is real but gradual. The dollar's share of global reserves has dropped from about 73% in 2001 to around 58% now. It's not collapsing — it's just slowly being chipped away at, transaction by transaction.

1.5.4 Subtopics

1.5.4.1 A BRICS Common Currency or Currency Unit — Feasibility and Challenges.

People talk about this a lot. A shared currency or even just a basket unit could give the group more independence. But the economies are very different — China is a manufacturing giant, Russia is resource-heavy, India is more services-driven. Agreeing on how it would work, who would control it, and how to handle different inflation rates is extremely hard. Right now it still feels more like a talking point than something close to happening.

1.5.4.2 Reducing vulnerability to US sanctions through de-dollarization.

This is one of the strongest practical reasons. Russia and Iran have already shown that moving trade and reserves away from the dollar (and SWIFT) can keep things running under sanctions. For other BRICS countries, reducing dollar dependence is partly about protecting themselves from the same kind of pressure later.

1.5.4.3 Balancing de-dollarization with maintaining economic stability and investor confidence.

If countries push too hard or too fast, investors may get nervous and currencies can get volatile. So there's a real balancing act — increasing local currency use without looking unstable or scaring capital away. The transition has to feel controlled.

1.5.4.4 Expanding the use of national currencies in intra-BRICS trade and investment agreements

This is the most realistic path and it's already happening. More bilateral deals are settling trade in yuan, rubles, rupees and so on instead of converting everything through dollars. It cuts costs and exchange-rate risk, and it doesn't require inventing a whole new currency first.

1.5.5 Questions a Resolution Must Answer

1. What specific measures should BRICS countries adopt to further increase the use of national currencies in intra-bloc trade and investment?

2. How can BRICS accelerate the development and implementation of alternative payment systems (such as BRICS Pay) to reduce dependence on SWIFT and the US dollar?

3. What steps should be taken to overcome the major challenges in creating a viable BRICS basket currency or common currency unit?

4. How can BRICS member states minimize economic risks and maintain investor confidence while actively pursuing de-dollarization?

5. How should BRICS balance short-term practical solutions (bilateral trade in local currencies) with long-term goals (multilateral financial architecture)?

6. How can BRICS countries encourage wider participation from non-member nations and Global South economies in local currency trade and payment arrangements?

7. What role should the New Development Bank (NDB) and other BRICS financial institutions play in promoting and financing projects using local currencies?

8. How can a BRICS currency unit or enhanced local currency framework be structured to avoid replicating the dollar's dominance, preventing its weaponization for geopolitical purposes, and ensuring it remains a neutral, stable, and equitable tool for international trade?

1.5.6 Useful Sites and Documents

Atlantic Council

atlanticcouncil.org

BIS (Bank for International Settlements)

bis.org

Carnegie Endowment

carnegieendowment.org

1.5.7 Glossary

De-dolarization: *The process of reducing dependence on the US dollar in international trade, reserves, and financial transactions.*

Local Currency Settlement: *Paying for trade and investments directly in the national currencies of the trading countries (e.g., yuan-ruble or rupee-ruble) instead of converting through USD.*

BRICS Currency Unit / Basket Currency: *A proposed common reference currency made up of a weighted basket of BRICS national currencies (similar to the IMF's SDR).*

BRICS Pay: *A developing BRICS digital payment platform designed to facilitate cross-border transactions in local currencies and serve as an alternative to SWIFT.*

SWIFT: *The dominant global financial messaging system that facilitates most international bank transfers, usually in US dollars.*

Currency Weaponization: *Using control over the global reserve currency (USD) to impose sanctions or freeze assets for political reasons.*

[Topic 2]

1.6 How to combat food scarcity while encouraging local production systems

1.6.1 Background Information

Food scarcity is a global issue that disproportionately affects emerging nations. The lack of reliable access to safe and nutritious food is enforced by heavy import reliance, weak infrastructure and climate vulnerability. With the United States providing the most foreign aid at $62 billion dollars annually, their requirements for aid pressure many countries to take decisions that favour the USA.e

With ongoing global conflicts, worldwide hunger increased to 1 in 11 people in 2024. Ultimately, the reliance on foreign aid not only just addresses the symptom of the underlying issue but also increases the debt of emerging economies which slows their progress. Many BRICS nations believe that the IMF and World Bank as well as other western-led aid organisations are unable to fulfill the needs of poorer countries and thus are pushing back.

The New Development Bank (NDB), formed in 2014 by BRICS, is working to replace the World Bank by offering loans guarantees, and other financial help with more equality among shareholders as well as greater flexibility and access to funds. During the same summit in 2014, BRICS established the Cognitive Reserve Arrangement (CRA), which allows BRICS countries to be supported during a currency crisis in place of the IMF with the USA's veto power.

1.6.2 Historical Context

Reliance on foreign food aid was not just caused due to disruptions in production, climate disasters, and economic problems but became an issue after World War 2 ended. The United States passed the Agricultural Act of 1954 which was meant to send extra farm goods overseas.

Food was used as a tool politically, economically, and commercially by the United States and other rich countries. Local food prices were kept low by sending away extra wheat and rice, communism was pushed away by providing meals to allied governments, and new buyers were found as poor nations became used to cheap food imports.

As food imports increased and continued, local farming decreased due to their inability to compete with the cheap foreign food. The local farms were also unable to produce large quantities of food because of their older infrastructure. With less local farms available, countries became dependent on foreign aid long-term as emergency food stores were not sufficient.

1.6.3 Current Situation

BRICS+ nations are facing both geopolitical and climate pressures that are causing food insecurity to change from a domestic issue into a matter of collective defense.

Following major maritime choke points as well as spikes in global fertilizer prices from 35% to 60%, BRICS is aggressively dissociating from western agricultural markets. In order to increase South-South exchange, BRICS nations have been finalizing the BRICS Grain Exchange which could turn into a 1 trillion US-dollar mechanism annually.

Russia’s proposal of the BRICS Grain Exchange’s concept and structure at the 16th meeting of the BRICS Economic and Foreign Trade ministers on August 6th and 7th shows the expedited push for a separation from Western financial institutions and agricultural aids.

BRICS+ has also institutionalized efforts to encourage local production though newly launched programs such as the AGRIN framework. The AGRIN framework which was established on June 13th, 2026 during the 16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers’ Meeting is aimed to strengthen food security and agricultural resilience. Collaborative networks for regenerative agriculture have also been formed in order to protect and help the Global South’s local farmers.

Internal disagreements do cause improvement to be slow as major exporters like Russia and Brazil compete for market dominance. At the same time Egypt, a large consumer nation, is struggling with high food inflation and India’s protective export restrictions cause problems in terms of trade due to a want to be self-sufficient.

Overall, BRICS+ nations are working hard to combat food scarcity issues but domestic policies and problems are continuing to stand in the way as well as the difficulty of moving away from the western markets.

1.6.4 Subtopics

1.6.4.1 Reformation of international agricultural trade infrastructure

Establishing a BRICS Grain Exchange to promote fair regional pricing without US-Dollar centers trade. With pricing separated actions by region, economies are protected from high foreign exchange rates. Countries will also be protected from Western sanctions, global market volatility and food weaponization.

1.6.4.2 Empowering small landowners and local seed sovereignty

To fundamentally change the issue of foreign reliance the increase of domestic production is greatly needed. Local farmers must be supported in ways that allow them to produce adequate products at reasonable prices. Reducing reliance on multinational agrochemical corporations who price gouge by creating local seed banks and fertilizer production.

1.6.4.3 Climate-resilient agriculture and South-South technology transfers

To ensure food security a change in food production and storage is needed. Local food systems must adapt to climate change and different climatic conditions to prevent loss of food. The storage of food should be able to vary from country to country without being labeled as 'unmodern' as long as it works. Democratizing precision farming, smart irrigation, and regenerative land management through emerging economies will allow farms to grow and food security to increase.

1.6.4.4 Post-harvest logistics and public food distribution safety nets

Fixing the gaps in the supply chain between production and consumption within BRICS+ nations can eliminate waste and foster trade. Creating regional frameworks that will improve food banks, school feeding programs, and public buffer stocks. Combating the loss of food will allow food insecurity to decrease.

1.6.5 Questions a Resolution Must Answer

1. What specific digital infrastructure and regulatory frameworks will govern the BRICS Grain Exchange to ensure stable, transparent intra-bloc agricultural trading?
2. What concrete clearing and settlement mechanisms should be adopted to transition agricultural trade into local currencies, effectively insulating member states from western financial system volatility and sanctions?
3. How can the new development bank be structurally optimized to provide low interest loans for regional grain storage, irrigation, and transport networks without creating unmanageable debt?
4. What collaborative policies can reduce susceptibility to global chemical market spikes by ramping up regional manufacturing of organic and synthetic fertilizers within the bloc?
5. How can member states legally protect family farmers from multinational agrochemical monopolies while scaling local, climate-resilient seed banks?
6. How can the committee mitigate internal friction caused by unilateral domestic expert bans and protectionist policies implemented during sudden food crises?
7. What binding guidelines will establish a coordinated BRICS+ emergency food reserve and public distribution framework to stabilize supply for high-inflation import nations?
8. What concrete logistical investments and regional frameworks are needed to build localized cold-chain storage and rural processing facilities to eliminate post-harvest food waste before it reaches markets?

1.6.6 Useful Sites and Documents

BRICS Portal

https://infobrics.org/

New Development Banks Publications

https://www.ndb.int/

The UN State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) Report

https://www.fao.org/publications/fao-flagship-publications/the-state-of-food-security-and-nutrition-in-the-world/en

WTO Agricultural Trade and Food Security Database

https://www.wto.org/english/tratop_e/agric_e/food_security_e.htm

BRICS Strategy on Food Security Cooperation

https://www.tralac.org/documents/resources/external-relations/brics/5064-brics-strategy-on-food-security-cooperation-2022/file.html

1.6.7 Glossary

BRICS Grain Exchange: *A proposed independent commodities trading platform designed to establish regional pricing benchmarks and bypass Western financial chokepoints.*

De-dollarization: *The strategic transition to settling intra-bloc agricultural trade using local national currencies instead of the US dollar.*

Small holder: *Small scale, family run agrarian producers who make up the majority of agricultural workforce across the Global South.*

Seed sovereignty: *The legal and practical right of local farmers to breed, save, and exchange diverse, climate-resilient indigenous seeds independently of multinational corporate patents.*

Agroecology: *A holistic farming framework that applies ecological concepts to agriculture, focusing on regenerative soil health and sustainable water management.*

Post-Harvest Loss: *The degradation or wasting of grown food within the supply chain before it ever reaches consumers, usually caused by poor storage and logistics.*